

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

Date: January 13, 2026

Time: 6:00pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person Meeting

Documents Discussed

FY27 Budget Proposals Narrative

FY2027 Budget (draft)

FY2027 Action Plan

Director's Report 1-13-26

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Anne Marie O'Reilly, Angela Griefen, Alison Thirkield, Rick Tracy, Deb Estelle, Jackie Brodeur

Alison Thirkield left the meeting at 6:50.

Absent: None

Call To Order: 6:01 pm

Minutes from Last meeting: To be submitted at February meeting.

Treasurer's Report

Building: \$3,594.48

State Aid: \$9,621.85

Deferred Town Monies (expenses): \$30,852.29

Deferred Town Monies (salaries): \$42,905.30

Gifts: \$26,982.48

Director's Report

Statistics:

Children's Programs: 11 children's programs with 80 attending

Adult Programs: 26 adult programs with 156 attending

Teen Programs: 1 teen programs with 3 attending

General Audience Programs: 0 general audience programs with 0 attending

Circulation: 1,581 (December 2025 – 1,733)

eBooks: 462 (December 2025 – 469)

Two library patrons have elected to donate annually from their retirement distributions, to the library gifts account. Meaghan Schwelm has sent an acknowledgement letter and personal note of gratitude.

Meaghan Schwelm met with Owen Bowman and Wade Clement to discuss plans for the front garden sculpture to honor the late Lyn Keating. The sculpture is planned for installation and dedication May 13, 2026, which will be the one year anniversary of Lyn's passing. The sculpture has been funded by donations from Lyn's family to the Friends.

Friends Report

The Friends discussed hosting a workshop on cultivating peace and joy at the library. The upcoming painting night has been very popular, with a wait list as long as the class size. The Friends are planning for their Spring newsletter and annual appeal.

Old Business

Discussed the FY27 Budget Proposal Narratives with some suggestions for further clarification of key details. Discussed the impact of different funding levels on meeting MAR requirements, and the consequences if MAR is not met. MAR will only use the operating budget voted on by the Town, and not any other sources of funds, such as gifts, in their determination. Discussed line items in FY2027 Budget draft, level service compared to austerity versions.

Discussed the FY2027 Action Plan.

Discussed the possibility of partnering with the Blacksmith Shop Museum to access grants for preservation of historical materials. The plan was unanimously approved, with a motion by Rick Tracy, seconded by Angela Griefen.

New Business

Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda

Motion to adjourn made by Jackie Brodeur; seconded by Angela Griefen. Approved unanimously.

Meeting Adjourned: 7:00 PM

Next Meeting: February 10, 2026, 6:00 PM

Submitted By: Alison Thirkield